

Numerical Analysis PhD Exam, May 1995

1. Consider the linear system $Ax = b$.
 - (a) Suppose the columns of A are linearly independent. Derive the normal equation for the x that minimizes the 2-norm of the residual $r = b - Ax$.
 - (b) Suppose that the rows of A are linearly independent. Derive the normal equation for the solution to $Ax = b$ that has the smallest 2-norm.
 - (c) Using the singular value decomposition, obtain a formula for the least squares solution to $Ax = b$. That is, if M denotes the set of all x for which the 2-norm of the residual is minimal, your formula should give the point in M with smallest 2-norm.
2. Suppose the columns of A are independent. Given the QR factorization of A , give a formula for the distance from some given vector b to the space spanned by the columns of A .
3. Verify the Woodbury formula

$$(B - UV^T)^{-1} = B^{-1} + B^{-1}U(I - V^TB^{-1}U)^{-1}V^TB^{-1}.$$

4. Explain how the singular value decomposition can be used to determine the rank of a matrix in the presence of rounding errors.
5. Derive a formula for the 2-norm of a matrix in terms of its singular values.
6. Let f be an $(n + 1)$ -times continuously differentiable function on the interval $[a, b]$, and let $a \leq x_0 < x_1 < \dots < x_n \leq b$. Let P_n be the unique polynomial interpolant of degree at most n , interpolating the data $(x_k, f(x_k))$, $k = 0, 1, \dots, n$. Prove that there exists a point $\xi \in [a, b]$ such that

$$f(x) - P_n(x) = \frac{f^{(n+1)}(\xi)}{(n+1)!} \prod_{k=0}^n (x - x_k)$$

for all $x \in [a, b]$.

7. Let f be a twice continuously differentiable function on the interval $[a, b]$, and $x_0, x_1, \dots, x_N$ be an equi-spaced partition of $[a, b]$, with step size h and $x_0 = a$. Assume that only the values $f(x_k)$, $k = 0, 1, \dots, N$, are known.
 - (a) State the trapezoidal rule $T(f, N)$ to approximate $\int_a^b f(x) dx$.
 - (b) Prove that

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx - T(f, N) = -\frac{(b-a)^3}{12N^2} f''(\xi)$$

for some point $\xi \in (a, b)$.

8. Let f be a twice continuously differentiable, 2π -periodic, function on $\mathbb{R}$ and consider the problem of computing the Fourier coefficients

$$c_n = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} e^{-inx} f(x) dx \tag{8.1}$$

by using the values $f_k = f(2k\pi/N)$ for $k = 0, 1, \dots, N - 1$.

- (a) Define the discrete Fourier transform $\{\hat{f}_n\}$ of the sequence $\{f_k\}$.
- (b) By applying the trapezoidal rule to the integral in (8.1), show that c_n can be approximated by $\hat{f}_n$.
- (c) By performing an analysis of the error in the approximation in (b), show that $\hat{f}_n$ is a poor approximation of c_n . Hint: Investigate behavior of error as $N \rightarrow \infty$.
- (d) Outline a method of obtaining a better approximation $\tilde{c}_n$ of c_n . (You do not need to actually find a formula for this $\tilde{c}_n$.) For the $\tilde{c}_n$ obtained by your method, define

$$\|\tilde{c} - c\|_\infty = \max\{|\tilde{c}_n - c_n|, n = 1, 2, \dots\}.$$

Find the order of convergence of $\|\tilde{c} - c\|_\infty$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$.

9. Give a careful statement of the contraction mapping theorem for functions defined on subsets of $\mathbb{R}^n$ into $\mathbb{R}^n$.

- (a) Since it is usually not easy to demonstrate the contraction property in particular examples, state a stronger condition which implies the contraction property.
- (b) Discuss the relative merits of determining the fixed points of a function $\varphi : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by the iterations:

$$(\text{FP}) \quad x_{k+1} = \varphi(x_k)$$

$$(\text{DFP}) \quad x_{k+1} = \varphi(\varphi(x_k))$$

$$(\text{STEF}) \quad x_{k+1} = x_k - \frac{(\varphi(x_k) - x_k)^2}{\varphi(\varphi(x_k)) - 2\varphi(x_k) + x_k}.$$

10. Let A be a real, positive definite $n \times n$ matrix and b be an $n \times 1$ vector.

- (a) Derive the steepest descent algorithm for approximating the true solution x of $Ax = b$, by a sequence of iterates $\{x_k\}$.
- (b) Define the real-valued function h on $\mathbb{R}^n$ by

$$h(x) = (Ax - b)^T A^{-1} (Ax - b)$$

and show that

$$h(x_{k+1}) \leq (1 - c(A)^{-1})^2 h(x_k)$$

where $c(A)$ is the condition number of the matrix A .